

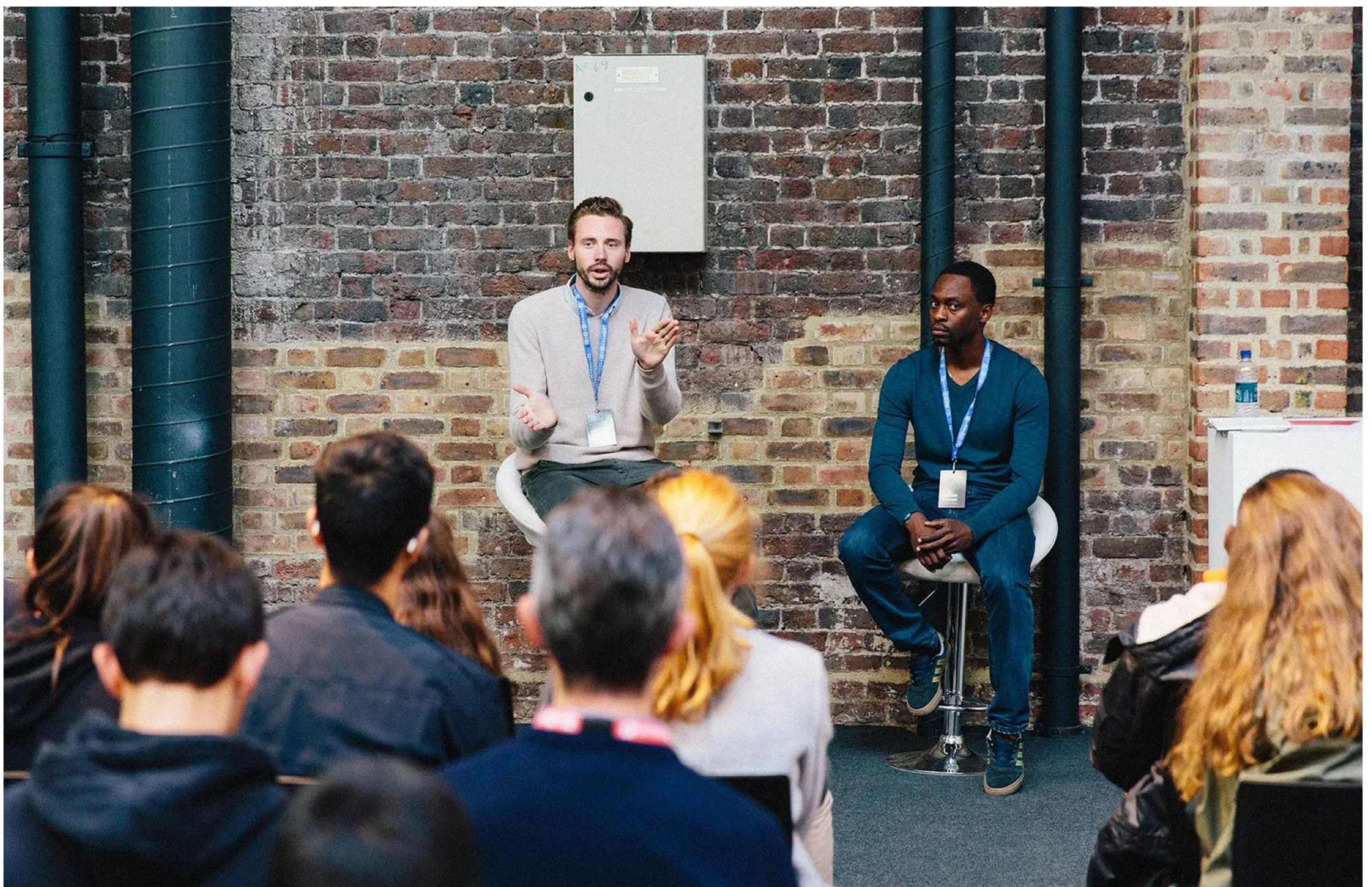
Exhibit 15

Wired UK - How to become an entrepreneur_ the ultimate guide to getting started

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Want to be an entrepreneur? The ultimate guide to getting started

WIRED Next Generation saw entrepreneurs sharing their insights about how to get going in startups

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Tim Groot, cofounder and CEO of artificial intelligence-powered event networking solution Grip (left) and Pierre-Simon Ntiruhungwa, head of programming at Founders of the Future (right) speaking at WIRED Next Generation MICHAEL NEWINGTON GRAY

“THERE IS NO playbook on becoming an entrepreneur, but it’s good to talk to people and get into the habit of talking to entrepreneurs,” says Tim Groot, co-founder and CEO of artificial intelligence-powered event networking solution Grip.

Lucky then, that he was on hand at WIRED Next Generation to answer questions posed by an audience of 12- to 18-year-old entrepreneurs in the making. Along with Pierre-Simon Ntiruhungwa, head of programming at Founders of the Future, these were the top tips they shared for anyone – no matter their age – looking to become an entrepreneur.

How do you come up with a startup idea?

Solve a problem you are familiar with. Groot launched Grip when he realised meeting the right people at conferences was completely inefficient. “When you see a problem, that is always a good point to start. Ask yourself, is this the most efficient way things can be done? It can be anything you are experiencing in daily life, in education – if there is something that annoys you and could be done better, fix it.”

How do you get your first user?

“A captivating story is really important,” says Groot. “You can have a solution, but if there is no bigger story it’s difficult to get traction in the beginning. Look at broader trends in technology – take a helicopter view of the world and be able to think about high level. For instance, I see in an issue of WIRED that chatbots are big a thing now. Think of that and a way of building your story into that – it’s a great way of getting press, and press is a great way to get users. You get traction by finding proof points in your concept you are able to leverage.”

How do you get funding?

“FFF – friends, family and fools. All three are likely your initial investors,” says Groot. “That is the traditional route. I would recommend starting your company with two or three others, then joining an accelerator. There are amazing programmes out there. You get space and exposure to a lot of mentors.” Accelerators like 500 Startups and Seedcamp help you meet investors and build

your network when you are just starting out and don't know a lot of people in the industry.

What if you don't have the technical skills to build your idea?

Try to figure out what the core idea you are trying to deliver is – you don't always need technology to present that. “Our idea was to connect people better at an event,” says Groot. “We could have started with an Excel spreadsheet of contacts, and five contact cards for each attendee to give out at events and connect people that way. You don't have to have a huge upfront platform in order to validate your idea. This is first principle thinking, which Elon Musk is a fan of – get to the core of what your company is trying to achieve and why you started it.”

Once you have decided that, you can acquire the skills you need to get to where you want to go, at university or via other routes. You can also bring people with technical skills onboard: “they will appreciate the fact you already have proof points”. “Bring in product people, friends from school or other classes. Great people often have very different experiences and you build great companies that way.”

Ntiruhungwa adds: “If you don't know how to code, you still can learn. If you have a product in mind, that is one of the best ways to learn efficiently. There are free online courses, and you can apply that knowledge directly to the project you have. You are in the best position to learn to code efficiently.”

How do relationships with investors work?

“It's like a marriage you go into, there is a tight collaboration between investor and founder,” says Groot. So you need to make sure those people understand what you are trying to do very well. Some people will be hands off and let you get on with the work, he points out. Others will be very hands on. Just be aware the investor doesn't have their own product vision. “If they are entrepreneurs themselves and have a very strong opinion of what to do, that can be very annoying for you as a person. You will get advice from everyone anyway, but it's about what you think is right – be very strong with your own beliefs and build on that. If you are convinced of your own story, investors will be impressed by that

and that is really key. They should invest because of you, not the business opportunity; not a puppet.”

As a founder, will you work 24/7?

“It depends on the person,” says Groot. “For me personally, it’s always on my mind but that’s also how I like it to be. It doesn’t mean you are always working, though. You can be taking your time, thinking about stuff and revisiting it. It’s about being able to reflect on things – that’s a key ability as humans. Then you can go back tomorrow and start refreshing it. If you have difficult moments, step away and relax and then reflect. Tomorrow you go back stronger.”

How do you do market research at the beginning?

You need to understand the person who is going to be using your product. There are plenty of research papers publicly available for different consumer sectors, but contacts are also key. “Approach them by looking at how to provide them with a service, rather than spamming them,” says Groot. “Maybe you have a great new insight into a subsect of their business, or you have a lot of research and you want to have their opinion.

People love knowing they are appreciated and their opinion is appreciated.” Some of the WIRED Next Generation attendees were concerned their age could be a hurdle. But Ntiruhungwa actually said it can have the opposite effect. “Someone will say, ‘oh they are 16, I won’t take them seriously – but someone else will be really impressed. Being young can open a lot of doors that won’t be open to others. Try to see if you can play that to your advantage. Tell them you are doing research for a school project, they will really love to talk to you.”

How do you learn to manage people?

“There is no apparent shortcut,” believes Groot. You can learn a lot about the different concepts and approaches from management books, but to understand “what moves people”, you just need experience. You need to understand how to motivate your team, and trust them.

Groot points out that it's easy to do a job yourself, when you know you can do it fast because you understand the concept already. But you need to be able to relinquish control. "You can't duplicate yourself constantly – you need to be able to get others to do things in the best way they think they can. The first time, you may need to give them an hour, but they will get better and faster. It's about being able to change the mindset as leader of the company, and give trust to people and make sure they feel they can do the best job ever. Motivate them in the right way." You can also talk to investors, says Groot, who might have experience in HR or psychology. Ntiruhungwa recommended books by Richard Branson and Ben Horowitz.

How do you know if your idea will gain traction?

Groot reiterated that entrepreneurs must get their product out as soon as possible – do not waste time and money building something you eventually discover no-one wants. It's the only way to be sure you are heading in the right direction. "Some startups raise money before they have a product. They feel the product is not good enough to launch. There are a lot of products out there that get killed before they are even launched. Get to the core of what you are trying to build and launch within a month. If you can't validate within a month, get to the core better, especially if you want to move fast and grow fast."

Practically speaking, it might not be possible to launch a full product that fast. So Groot recommends launching a landing page with a one paragraph description, and spending a small amount of money running some Google Adwords or Facebook ads. "Create a very simple 15-second video to promote to a specific audience you think are interested, those that click through to a landing page. People will be asked to leave their email address, then you can talk to them. Co-create initially with them and see if there is demand from this specific group. Then build a small version of the product. Uber started by just taking phone calls from friends who wanted a cab. Now it's worth \$60bn."

How do you get a work-life balance?

Think about what's really important to you and why you are interested in doing it, says Ntiruhungwa. "If you have a long pathway to get there, get yourself into a

rhythm.” He suggests spending one or two hours a day on a project rather than pulling all-nighters.

“Build regularity into your schedule, do your homework in advance so you have enough time. I wake up super early to do sports in the morning to give myself energy for the day. You know you have X hours of school and homework, it’s how you build around it so you can meet people, rest, and see some friends.” Groot recommends focusing on only the most important things, and doing the most difficult tasks – “those are the ones that make you better”.

How do you meet people with more market experience than you?

Both speakers suggested using LinkedIn. It will provide you with an overview of the people working within the sector you are focussing on. Find the most relevant companies and contact people there – “they don’t always need to be the most important people in the company”. Ntiruhungwa also suggested working as an intern for a startup in the right sector – shadow the CEO.

More in our 'how to become an entrepreneur' series

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- [Want to be a success? You need passion, purpose, persistence – and be able to code](#) – [Entrepreneurs need two brains; one left, one right](#)
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